

Audit Completion — Outstanding Blockers

What is preventing the e-commerce audit backlog from reaching 100% · 23 July 2026

18 TASKS COMPLETE	10 BLOCKED	6 NEED CLIENT ANSWERS	1 BLOCKING LAUNCH
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The engineering backlog is exhausted. Every task that could be completed from the codebase alone has been. The remaining ten items are each waiting on something outside our control: a decision or asset from the client, backend work that must land first, or a scoping call. **Six of the ten resolve with a single round-trip of client answers** — including the one item standing between the current build and launch. Only item 07 could be started unilaterally, and it is post-launch work by priority.

Critical — blocks launch 1 item

01 Braintree production credentials

CLIENT

Priority P1 · Scope Both storefronts · Engineering Complete

The payment integration is finished and correct, but still points at Braintree's **sandbox** environment. Hardcoded sandbox keys were removed from source and replaced with environment variables, so no further code work is required — the site simply cannot accept a real payment until production credentials exist.

This is the only remaining P1 and the sole hard blocker to going live.

WHAT WE NEED FROM THE CLIENT

- Production Merchant ID
- Production Public Key
- Production Private Key

WHAT WE DO ON RECEIPT

Set `BRAINTREE_ENV=production` in the hosting environment, then run one live end-to-end transaction and confirm it settles. Same day.

Growth & optimisation 4 items

02 Blog content — shared pool or split per brand?

CLIENT

Priority P2 · Scope Both storefronts · Found During item-by-item review

Both storefronts draw their `/blogs` articles from the same WordPress feed. The two sites style the articles differently, but the underlying content is identical — a fireplace article on the Solana site is the same article a BBQ shopper sees. This was not in the original audits; it surfaced during the follow-up review.

DECISION REQUIRED

- **Keep shared** — one content pipeline, simplest. Accepts off-topic articles on both sites.
- **Split per brand** — content matches each storefront. Requires sorting existing posts into two buckets and publishing to the correct one going forward.

03 Social presence beyond Facebook and Pinterest

CLIENT

Priority P2 · Scope Both storefronts · Effort once unblocked Under an hour

Both footers currently link only Facebook and Pinterest. Adding further channels is trivial engineering; the entire constraint is that the accounts must exist and we must have their URLs. Where an account is not yet live we will leave it out rather than ship a placeholder — a dead social link damages trust more than an absent one.

WHAT WE NEED FROM THE CLIENT

Account URLs for any of: Instagram, YouTube, TikTok, X/Twitter, LinkedIn — plus confirmation of which, if any, are still to be created.

04 Courier and shipment tracking in Order History

BACKEND

Priority P2 · Scope Both storefronts · Hardest dependency on this list

Order History today shows only internal status — pending, paid, shipped and so on. It shows no carrier and no tracking number, which is the single most common post-purchase support question in this category.

This is not a front-end gap. The order API returns no carrier or tracking fields at all, so there is nothing available to display. The interface work is quick, but strictly downstream of the backend change.

PREREQUISITE

The order API must expose carrier name and tracking number per shipment. Front-end work follows immediately once those fields are available.

05 Email marketing platform — dedicated ESP or custom backend?

CLIENT

Priority P2 · Scope Both storefronts · Blocked by Client decision, then backend

Newsletter signup posts to our own backend, which stores the subscriber — and that is all it does. There is no campaign builder, no automated welcome series, no abandoned-cart sequence and no deliverability tooling.

This compounds with work already built: the cart already tracks abandonment and records it server-side, but nothing sends the follow-up email. That captured data is currently going unused.

DECISION REQUIRED

- **Connect Klaviyo or Mailchimp** — campaigns, automations and segmentation out of the box; monthly cost scales with list size.
- **Stay custom** — no licence cost, but lifecycle emails must be built and maintained, with no self-serve campaign tool for the client.

Future enhancements 5 items

06 Order confirmation and receipt email flow

EXTERNAL

Priority P3 · Scope Both storefronts

Confirmation emails are dispatched by an external backend service rather than this application, so their behaviour cannot be verified by reading or running this codebase. We can neither confirm nor rule out a problem from here.

TO CLOSE THIS OUT

A live test order, or confirmation from whoever administers the mail service. Cheap to verify — it simply needs access we do not have.

07 Core Web Vitals and gallery image optimisation

SCOPING

Priority P3 · Scope Both storefronts · No external dependency

The one item on this list with no outside dependency. It extends the existing homepage performance work to large product galleries. It is held only by priority — it is post-launch work — not by any blocker.

STATUS

Can begin immediately on your instruction. Prior homepage performance findings are already documented and would be the starting point.

08 Programmatic SEO across 6,000+ products

SCOPING

Priority P3 · Scope Both storefronts

Unique meta titles and descriptions at catalogue scale. The engineering is straightforward; the open question is editorial — what the templates should say, and how much is machine-generated against hand-written for priority lines.

PREREQUISITE

A content strategy decision on template wording and the generated / hand-written split, before implementation can be scoped.

09 Loyalty and rewards programme

CLIENT

Priority P3 · Scope Both storefronts · Status Not built, not planned

Repeat-purchase incentives are a meaningful revenue lever in this category, but this is a substantial build that requires a commercial decision before any technical scoping is worthwhile.

DECISION REQUIRED

Whether to proceed at all — and if so, the broad shape: points on purchase, tiered discounts, referral credit, or another model.

10 Legacy brand microsite pages

CLIENT

Priority P3 · Scope BBQ Grill Outlet · Risk Accruing maintenance debt

Two pages — `/brand/bbq-grill-outlet` and `/brand/solana-bbq-grills` — predate the current two-brand architecture and sit outside it entirely, carrying their own hardcoded metadata. They function today, but they do not inherit brand changes, so every future update must be applied to them by hand and they will silently drift out of sync.

DECISION REQUIRED

- **Retire and redirect** to the equivalent current pages — cleanest.
- **Rebuild** inside the current architecture — more work, stays consistent.
- **Leave as-is** — accepts ongoing drift and manual upkeep.

The deciding question is whether these pages still receive traffic or support an active campaign.

Summary

#	ITEM	PRIORITY	BLOCKED BY
01	Braintree production credentials	P1	Client — credentials
02	Blog content pool — shared or split	P2	Client — decision
03	Social presence beyond two channels	P2	Client — account URLs
04	Courier / shipment tracking	P2	Backend — API fields absent
05	Email marketing platform	P2	Client decision, then backend
06	Order confirmation email flow	P3	External service — no access
07	Core Web Vitals / gallery images	P3	Scoping only — startable now
08	Programmatic SEO at scale	P3	Scoping — content strategy
09	Loyalty / rewards programme	P3	Client — product decision
10	Legacy brand microsites	P3	Client — decision

Recommended next action. Six of these ten — items 01, 02, 03, 05, 09 and 10 — are client questions that can be answered in a single round-trip. Sending them as one batch unblocks the majority of the remaining backlog, including the only item preventing launch. Item 07 can start today if you would like movement in parallel.

Derived from the Solana and BBQ e-commerce audits of 22 July 2026 and the subsequent item-by-item code review. Progress tracked in `docs/audit-tasklist.md`; client-facing questions drafted in `docs/audit-client-questions.md`.